SCOUTS BSA TEST LAB SERIES

DANCE



Scouting America

Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 1: Dance Injury Prevention, Warm-Ups & First Aid

Preventing Injury. Do the following: (a) Explain to your counselor how you can prevent injuries while participating in dancing activities and what you should do to anticipate, help prevent, mitigate, and respond to these hazards. Explain what you need to take into consideration before trying potentially dangerous moves including but not limited to jumps, flips, and lifts. (b) Explain to your counselor how to appropriately warm-up prior to dancing activities to protect joints and prevent injury. Demonstrate three dance warm-ups. (c) Show that you know first aid for injuries that could occur while dancing, including cuts, scratches, abrasions, concussions, blisters, sprains, stress fractures, tendonitis, and back injuries. (d) Explain the importance of wearing the right clothing and gear for dance, including appropriate footwear.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Dance Sub-Req 1a: Explain to your counselor how you can prevent injuries while participating in dancing activities and what you should do to anticipate, help prevent, mitigate.
- Dance Sub-Req 1b: Explain to your counselor how to appropriately warm-up prior to dancing activities to protect joints and prevent injury. Demonstrate three dance warm-ups.
- Dance Sub-Req 1c: Show that you know first aid for injuries that could occur while dancing, including cuts, scratches, abrasions, concussions, blisters, sprains, stress fractures.
- Dance Sub-Req 1d: Explain the importance of wearing the right clothing and gear for dance, including appropriate footwear.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 2: The Five Elements of Dance (BASTE Framework)

Elements of Dance. Describe the 5 Elements of dance: Body, Action (Relationships), Space, Time, and Energy.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Core Standard 1 (Req 2): Elements of Dance.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 2): Describe the 5 Elements of dance: Body, Action (Relationships), Space, Time, and Energy.
- Safety & Policy Alignment: Follow the BSA Guide to Safe Scouting, Two-Deep Leadership, and the Buddy System during all Dance Req 2 activities.
- Counselor Conference Readiness: Be prepared to describe your findings and personal reflections on The Five Elements of Dance (BASTE Framework) with your Merit Badge Counselor.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 3: Exploring Six Styles of Partner, Solo & Group Dance

Styles of Dance. Name and briefly describe SIX types or styles of dancing from the following list, noting if this is a dance that may be performed alone, if the dance generally requires a partner or group, or if it could be either a solo or partner dance. (a) Acrobatics/Acro Dance (b) Aerial (Silks, Hoop, etc.) (c) Ballet (d) Ballroom dances (e) Breakdancing (f) Clogging (g) Contemporary/Modern dance (h) Country-Western (i) Folk & Traditional/Cultural (j) Hip Hop (k) Jazz (l) Latin dances (m) Square dances (n) Swing dance (o) Tap dance

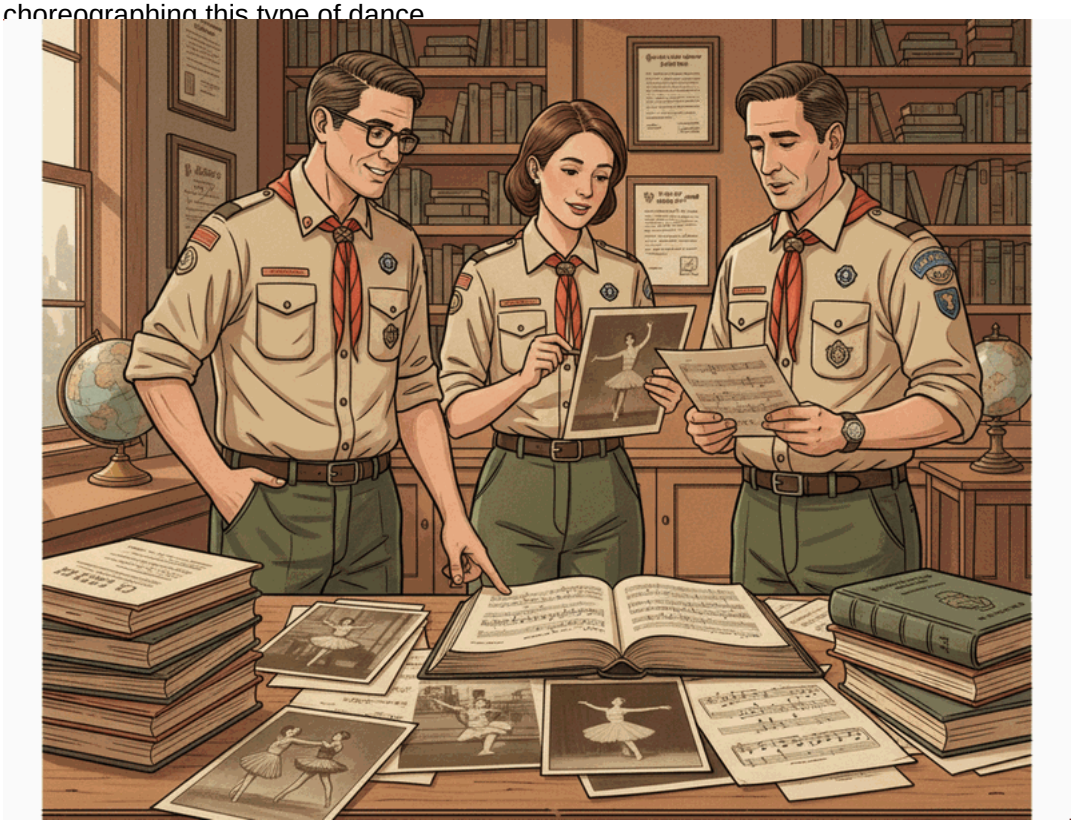
Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Dance Sub-Req 3a: Acrobatics/Acro Dance.
- Dance Sub-Req 3b: Aerial (Silks, Hoop, etc.).
- Dance Sub-Req 3c: Ballet.
- Dance Sub-Req 3d: Ballroom dances.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 4: Dance History, Choreography & Adaptive Inclusivity

Research. Research TWO of the types of dance you learned about in requirement 3 by doing the following for EACH type of dance you chose: (a) Give a brief history, including its origin, how it came to be in the United States if it originated elsewhere, and where in the world/country it is most often performed. (b) Name/describe different variations of this style of dancing, if any. (c) Name some specific types of dance steps/moves particular to this type of dance. Does this dance tell a story through movement? If so, please describe. (d) Include information on at least one person who became well-known performing, teaching, or choreographing this type of dance. (e) Note if anyone with a physical disability (such a person with hearing or sight impairment or a person who uses a wheelchair) could participate in this type of dancing. What accommodations would that person need to participate? (f) Locate and share a place near you/in your state where you could watch or participate in this type of dance as a part of a performance, competition, or class. Find out when and where this is offered and what the cost would be to watch or participate. (g) Watch a performance of this type of dance and discuss with your counselor. (While viewing an in-person performance is preferable, a recorded performance may also be permitted.)

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Dance Sub-Req 4a: Give a brief history, including its origin, how it came to be in the United States if it originated elsewhere, and where in the world/country it is most often.
- Dance Sub-Req 4b: Name/describe different variations of this style of dancing, if any.
- Dance Sub-Req 4c: Name some specific types of dance steps/moves particular to this type of dance. Does this dance tell a story through movement? If so, please describe.
- Dance Sub-Req 4d: Include information on at least one person who became well-known performing, teaching, or choreographing this type of dance.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 5: Rehearsing Warm-Ups & Performing a Dance Routine

Learn and Perform a Dance. Do the following: (a) Learn a dance. Use at least THREE types of warm-ups prior to your routine to prepare different muscle groups for the exercise. The dance may be solo, group, or partner dance and can use a memorized choreographed routine or an improvised dance. It should be a minimum of 2 minutes long or several shorter dances that add up to at least 2 minutes. The dance should demonstrate at least three different dance moves/steps and should contain music with Scout-appropriate lyrics, if applicable. (b) Perform the dance for your counselor or submit a video of your performance to your counselor. Describe to your counselor what precautions you took to avoid injury before and during your performance. Name or describe the 3 different dance moves that you learned, the 3 different warm-ups you chose, and the 5 Elements of Dance in your routine.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Dance Sub-Req 5a: Learn a dance.
- Dance Sub-Req 5b: Perform the dance for your counselor or submit a video of your performance to your counselor.
- Core Standard 1 (Req 5): Learn and Perform a Dance.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 5): (a) Learn a dance.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 6: Dance Careers, Choreography & Lifelong Fitness

Careers. Do ONE of the following: (a) Explore careers related to Dance. Research one career to learn about the training and education needed, costs, job prospects, salary, job duties, and career advancement. Your research methods may include ? with your parent or guardian?s permission ? an internet or library search, an interview with a professional in the field, or a visit to a location where people in this career work. Discuss with your counselor both your findings and what about this profession might make it an interesting career. (b) Explore how you could use knowledge and skills from dance to pursue a hobby. Research any training needed, expenses, and organizations that promote or support it. Discuss with your counselor what short-term and long-term goals you might have if you pursued this.

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Dance Sub-Req 6a: Explore careers related to Dance.
- Dance Sub-Req 6b: Explore how you could use knowledge and skills from dance to pursue a hobby.
- Core Standard 1 (Req 6): Do ONE of the following: (a) Explore careers related to Dance.
- Core Standard 2 (Req 6): Research one career to learn about the training and education needed, costs, job prospects, salary, job duties, and career advancement.



Scouting America Merit Badge Reference Guide: Dance
Req 7: Scouting America Test Lab Feedback & Evaluation

Complete the survey below to complete the test lab requirements

Key Pamphlet Study Points:
- Core Standard 1 (Req 7): Complete the survey below to complete the test lab requirements.
- Key Terminology & Evidence: Document specific examples, definitions, and field observations for Scouting America Test Lab Feedback & Evaluation in your Dance Workbook.
- Safety & Policy Alignment: Follow the BSA Guide to Safe Scouting, Two-Deep Leadership, and the Buddy System during all Dance Req 7 activities.
- Counselor Conference Readiness: Be prepared to complete your findings and personal reflections on Scouting America Test Lab Feedback & Evaluation with your Merit Badge Counselor.

